

Mehak Sharma

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Education

University of Cincinnati, Carl H. Lindner College of Business Cincinnati, OH
Bachelor of Business Administration, Finance & Business Economics. Expected: May 2026
University Honors Program **GPA:3.97/4.0**

Awards and Honors: Selected Participant – McKinsey Forward Program (2025), Invited Participant – 2024 Forbes Under 30 Summit; Selected Participant – PNC’s Leadership Series: EmpowHer Brilliance (2024); Harvard Global Case Competition Participant (2024); PACEsetter Distinction (2023–2025); King Scholar (2024, 2025); Kautz-Uible Fellow (2024, 2025); Dean’s List (6x); Vanderbilt University Prompt Engineering Certificate Holder; Collegiate DECA Top 10 National Finalist (2023); Lindner College of Business International Outreach Scholarship; Miss Teen India (2021); Study Abroad – Scandinavia (Norway, Sweden, Denmark); Study Tour – Dubai, United Arab Emirates; Founding Committee Member – Women in Finance; Founding Committee Member – Women in Entrepreneurship.

Relevant Coursework: Corporate Finance, Business Finance, Investments, Financial Information & Valuation, Economics of Stock Market & Trading, Portfolio Management, Cases in Corporate Finance & Johnson Investment Council Portfolio Management, Econometrics, Behavioral Economics, Intermediate Microeconomics & Macroeconomics, Business Analytics I & II, Applied Calculus I & II, Global Business Environment, Legal Environment of Business, Operations Management; supplemented by Breaking into Wall Street Training (Accounting, Discounted Cash Flow (DCF) Valuation, Leveraged Buyouts (LBO), Mergers & Acquisitions (M&A), and Equity Valuation Models).

Work Experience

Summer Analyst (Finance Specialization) June 2025–August 2025
Compass Lexecon (FTI Consulting) Chicago, IL

- Conducted valuation, econometric modeling, and industry research to assess financial stability, competition, and market efficiency in billion-dollar M&A, securities, and high-stakes antitrust cases; contributed to evidence-based case strategy through structured analytical work.
- Synthesized large financial datasets, regulatory frameworks, and industry trends into litigation-ready reports and exhibits; collaborated with senior economists and attorneys to deliver insights that shaped arguments with implications for competition policy and market regulation.

Investment Banking Analyst January 2025–March 2025
Two Roads Advisors New York, NY

- Conduct comprehensive industry, buyer, and target research, leveraging financial analysis, DCF, LBO, and M&A models to identify strategic opportunities and support deal sourcing, execution, and accurate financial projections for investment decisions.
- Created client-facing pitch books, transaction materials, and presentations for private equity-backed and high-growth businesses, supporting capital flows, investment decisions, and corporate expansion strategies in the middle-market space.

Portfolio Management Intern September 2024–December
Ameriprise Financial 2024 Crestview Hills, KY

- Conducted in-depth sector and company analysis for U.S. Large Cap equity strategies, assessing macroeconomic indicators (interest rates, inflation, sectoral growth) to deliver investment recommendations adopted by the Investment Committee, directly influencing strategic asset allocation and portfolio optimization.
- Authored a report on catastrophe bond funds (Amundi & Pioneer), integrating climate risk, insurance-linked securities, and macroeconomic factors into diversification strategies; findings guided portfolio discussions on sustainable investment and financial resilience.

Venture Capital Analyst August 2023–October 2023
University of Cincinnati Center of Entrepreneurship Cincinnati, OH

- Evaluated UC-affiliated startups for a \$1M student-led venture fund, leading due diligence on market size, financial projections, and competitive dynamics to identify high-growth investment opportunities.
- Collaborated with founding teams to stress-test business models and traction metrics, delivering investment recommendations that balanced scalability potential with portfolio risk exposure.

Investment Analyst Intern March 2024–August 2024
Andromeda Wealth Ltd Mumbai, IN

- Researched and evaluated mutual funds, insurance products, and investment portfolios to develop client-focused financial strategies, improving portfolio optimization and sales outcomes.
- Analyzed consumer behavior and market trends to support the development of automated financial instruments, enabling data-driven decision-making in product design and distribution.

Leadership and Professional Development Experience

PNC EmpowerHer Brilliance | Leadership Series Participant | Pittsburgh, PA December 2024–December 2024

- Selected as 1 of 40 women nationwide for PNC’s EmpowerHer Brilliance program, emphasizing women’s leadership in corporate and investment banking.
- Completed executive-led workshops on client management, capital markets, and career pathways; applied insights directly to finance internships and student leadership roles.

Harvard Global Case Competition (GCC) | Delegate | Virtual / Boston, MA April 2024–April 2024

- Competed in Harvard’s global M&A case challenge with 3,000+ participants, analyzing an \$8.5B cross-border merger scenario.
- Built DCF and comparable company analysis within a 72-hour deadline, collaborating with an international team across time zones; reinforced global problem-solving and financial leadership skills.

Forbes Under 30 Summit | Invited Participant | Cincinnati, OH

April 2024-April 2024

- Invited to Forbes Under 30 Summit to represent Nexus Flair, pitching to buyers and investors and securing \$10K+ in monthly wholesale growth opportunities.

Economics Society Study Tour| Selected Participant | New York, NY

January 2024-January 2024

- Selected for an economics program study tour, engaging directly with Morgan Stanley, U.S. Bank, Compass Lexecon, and Goldman Sachs executives to apply economic theory to finance and consulting practice.
- Collaborated with peers and faculty to distill insights from firm visits, applying executive perspectives to strengthen economic analysis and inform future career development strategies.

Queen City Consulting| Analyst | Cincinnati, OH

August 2023 – Present

- Designed a scalable adoption and pricing model for Xeurix, a 3D AI simulation startup, through market research, competitor benchmarking, and stakeholder interviews.
- Synthesized client insights into actionable recommendations and presented structured business models to executives, demonstrating adaptability and solution-driven thinking.

Lindner Investment Banking Club | Small Group Leader | Cincinnati, OH

August 2023–December 2023

- Directed M&A case study teams analyzing e-commerce targets for Amazon, guiding peers in applying financial modeling and valuation techniques to assess strategic fit.
- Coordinated and facilitated weekly training sessions for 30+ members, leading technical workshops and deal discussions while mentoring new analysts in modeling practices and case preparation.

Kautz Uible Economics institute | Professional Development Fellow | Cincinnati, OH

August 2023 – Present

- Awarded \$3,000+ experiential funding and executive mentorship as 1 of 12 fellows selected across the College of Business for entrepreneurial leadership.
- Directed fellowship funding to pilot Nexus Flair's U.S. retail entry, advancing boutique partnerships and pitching to Macy's supplier program.

Women in Finance & Women in Entrepreneurship | Founding Member | Cincinnati, OH

August 2022 – August 2023

- Co-founded Women in Finance & Entrepreneurship, mobilizing 50+ students through panels, mentorship, and industry events to expand leadership pathways in business careers.
- Organized 5+ panels and networking events, coordinating faculty and professional speakers to expand visibility. Promoted leadership opportunities and professional development, increasing student participation in industry events.

UC DECA | Director of Finance | Orlando, FL and Cincinnati, OH

August 2022-August 2023

- Directed sponsorship outreach and campus fundraising campaigns that financed student participation at state and national DECA competitions. Managed travel and competition logistics for UC's delegation to the International Career Development Conference (ICDC), supporting broader member access and visibility.
- Represented UC at ICDC, earning Top 10 National Finalist honors and an Academic Test Award for excellence in business case analysis.

Nexus Flair| Business Strategist| Navi Mumbai, IN

January 2021- August 2022

- Co-founded and scaled a women-led luxury accessories brand specializing in handcrafted pashmina scarves, leather handbags, and jewelry, reaching consistent \$10K+ monthly profits.
- Directed global supply chain and financial strategy across India, Dubai, and U.S., overseeing pricing, cost controls, and margin analysis to position Nexus Flair for luxury market entry.
- Negotiated 7 wholesale partnerships with boutiques in Chicago and Dubai and advanced B2B pitches to Macy's and Falguni Shane Peacock, positioning the brand for international growth.
- Achieved ISO certifications (ISO 9001, 14001, 27001, 10002) in sustainability, customer satisfaction, and quality management; designed fair-wage systems and ethical sourcing policies.
- Built e-commerce presence, integrating SEO strategy and digital storytelling to expand reach and enhance cultural branding.

Academic Projects & International Experiences

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- Selected for McKinsey's Forward Program, a global initiative building early-career skills in problem-solving and leadership.
 - Pitched Broadcom for inclusion in the Johnson Investment Counsel Student Fund, which invests UC scholarship assets; conducted valuation and industry analysis and presented recommendations to the faculty-led investment committee managing the endowment.
 - Developed a \$1 million investing portfolio comprising small and large-cap stocks, bonds, mutual funds, ETFs, commodities, and options in a simulation competition, ultimately winning first prize in the class. Used a meticulous approach to evaluate stocks based on market value, cashflow, and growth, achieving a 142.6% return with a well-balanced investment strategy.
 - Studied abroad in Norway, Sweden, and Denmark, meeting with executives at IKEA, Carlsberg, and DNV to analyze ESG integration, supply chain innovation, and Nordic economic models, applying insights to cross-cultural business prospects.

Skills and Strong Suits

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- Discounted Cash Flow (DCF), Leveraged Buyout (LBO), Mergers & Acquisitions (M&A), Comparable Company Analysis, Precedent Transactions, Accretion/Dilution Modeling, Scenario Analysis, Sensitivity Analysis, Portfolio Construction, Asset Allocation, Equity Valuation, Fixed Income Valuation, Catastrophe Bond (CAT Bond) Analysis, Risk Optimization, Economic Damages Assessment, Securities Litigation Analysis, Antitrust and Competition Policy Analysis, Regulatory Impact Studies, Market Structure Analysis, Regression Analysis, Time-Series Forecasting, Game Theory Applications, Stata, R, Python, Microsoft Excel (Advanced VBA, Solver), Microsoft Access, Microsoft Outlook, Capital IQ, PitchBook, FactSet, Bloomberg Terminal, Morningstar Direct, London Stock Exchange Group (LSEG) Workspace, IBISWorld, ImportYeti, Power BI, Salesforce, Report and Exhibit Design, Investor Presentations, Data Visualization.